



Expanse revived by Amazon

After Syfy dropped sci-fi show The Expanse, Jeff Bezos confirmed that it will continue on Amazon Prime. <https://digit.in/jun18-A35-1>



iOS 12 door unlock

iOS 12 will expand the NFC capabilities of iPhones to allow users to securely unlock doors with the tech. <https://digit.in/jun18-A35-2>

OnePlus 6

Still Standing "Tall"

The OnePlus 6 that launched in India for ₹34,999 is an embodiment of a simple enough philosophy. Give people what they want at a price that would put flagship phone makers to shame. The phone brings to the table turbo-powered performance powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon 845 chipset coupled with up to 8GB of RAM and 256GB of storage. It's built for speed from the ground up. Right from the minimal touch latency of the display to the meticulous optimisations of the Oxygen OS that powers the user experience. That has always been the case. Matching the speed and performance of flagship phones has been the signature of OnePlus devices. Only this time, the OnePlus 6 tries not only to play the part of a flagship, but also look the part of one.

Camera

The camera(s) at the back of the phone is now one of the most important aspect of choosing a smartphone. And that's where the OnePlus 6 falters. The phone uses a 16-megapixel + 20-megapixel dual camera stack at the back. That's the same resolution as the OnePlus 5T but few things have changed inside.

What's irksome is that OnePlus had a perfectly good solution for providing 2X hybrid zoom in the OnePlus 5, but they walked away from it on the OnePlus 5T and now the OnePlus 6. The zoom in the OnePlus 6 is completely digital, and no matter how much OnePlus claims they use multi-frame processing to get a clean zoom, there's a significant and noticeable loss in detail with a lack of sharpness.

Performance

The OnePlus 6 is the first phone in India to be powered by the Qualcomm



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Snapdragon 845. Needless to say, it's the fastest mobile platform available for Android devices right now. Although, benchmark reports will peg the Galaxy S9 slightly higher than the OnePlus 6. The AnTuTu 7.0 score was 244517 while the OnePlus 6 scores 2372

and 8502 on Geekbench Single Core and Multi-core CPU test respectively.

Well, it's certainly fast and if you're thinking of upgrading from the OnePlus 5T, you're likely to not feel the difference at all. The phone can switch between apps in a snap, open apps in an instant and while gaming, there's never a frame drop. The Game Mode that was a hit among users in the 5T has been improved by allowing users to take calls from the speaker while in a game, apart from limiting other apps from accessing the network to allow online games like PUBG mobile to have lower latencies.

The OxygenOS interface, OnePlus claims now opens apps 11 times faster. Considering how fast it anyway was,

the difference is hardly noticeable. The interface is still as near to stock Android we've seen yet housing a lot of optimisations and tweaks.

Battery life

The OnePlus 6 is powered by a 3,300 mAh battery that feels paltry in comparison to what the power banks-disguised-as-phones like the Huawei P20 Pro provide. And that shows when you're using the phone. Because of the high-end hardware, the battery drains quite fast, so much so, that you are left with around 5-6 percent of battery after a typical work day. It does need a top up in the evening if you decide to head out after work. That topup is provided by the Dash Charger that can fully charge the battery under an hour. The Dash Charger remains an integral part of the OnePlus experience. It's the reason why OnePlus can get away with putting a smaller battery on its phones every time. In the PCMark Work 2.0 Battery Test, the phone lasted 5 hours 46 minutes which isn't up to the standards at all. Interestingly, the benchmark test revealed the discharge is consistent till 20 percent after which it drops drastically.

Verdict

The OnePlus 6 is built for speed from the ground up. The smartphone has the history of being a flagship killer, but despite the top-of-the-class hardware, the compromises in OnePlus phones have also remained consistent, so much so, that it is now acts as a deterrent to buy this over an expensive flagship. The OnePlus 6 is still just as fast, even more beautiful but has the same flaws as last time.

—Subhrojit Malik

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Snapdragon 845 | GPU: Adreno 630 | OS: Android 8.1 (Oreo) | CARD SLOT: microSD, up to 128 GB | DISPLAY TYPE: Optic AMOLED | SIZE: 6.28 inches | RESOLUTION: 1080 x 2280 pixels | CAMERA PRIMARY: Dual (16 MP + 20MP)(f/1.7, 27mm, EIS | CAMERA SECONDARY: 16 MP (f/2.0, 1. µm pixel size).

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